

BUILDING A CASTLE

A master mason would be employed to plan and build a castle. The work could take years and provided jobs for many local people, from quarry workers and stone-porters to carpenters, and well-diggers.



Stonemason wears a coif (cloth cap) to show his profession

PULLEY WORK

Workers use a pulley to haul a basket of stone up to where it is needed.

SIEGE WEAPONS

There were two ways for attackers to overcome the defences of a castle.

They could either take it by force by battering down the gate, climbing the walls, or tunnelling under the defences. Or they could surround the castle and starve those inside until they surrendered or died, which might take a long time.



TREBUCHET

Used to hurl heavy stones at castle walls.



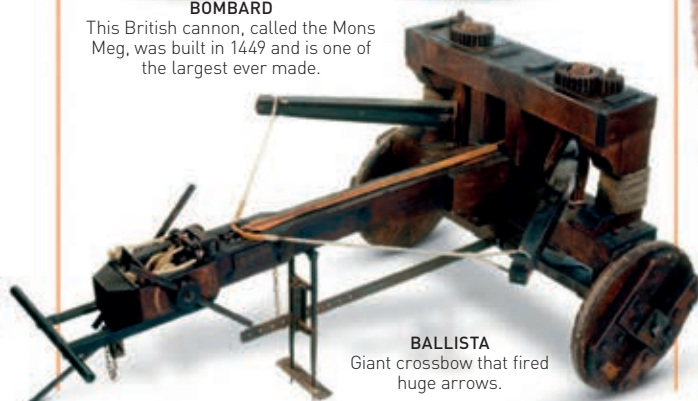
LONGBOW

Used to shoot arrows at long range.



BOMBARD

This British cannon, called the Mons Meg, was built in 1449 and is one of the largest ever made.



BALLISTA

Giant crossbow that fired huge arrows.

WHO'S WHO IN THE CASTLE

The household of a great castle in medieval Europe could easily contain 400 people. It was a busy place as servants, craftsmen, soldiers, and entertainers went about their various jobs.



THE LORD AND HIS FAMILY



GARRISON

The armed troops who were stationed in the castle to defend it.



CHAPLAIN

Led worship in the castle's chapel.



CONSTABLE

The lord's second-in-command, also called a castellan.



GONG FARMER

Dug and cleaned out the castle's toilets.



HUNTSMAN, FALCONER, DOG-KEEPER

Outside servants, each with a specific purpose on the lord's estate.



SEAMSTRESS

One of the many domestic servants who looked after the lord and his family.

PAGES, SQUIRES, AND KNIGHTS

Knights led the force that defended a lord's castle and lands. They were noblemen who pledged to fight for the lord whenever he needed them. In return, knights were paid well and granted lands of their own.

PAGE

A knight started his career at the age of seven, as a page. A page would serve meals and carry messages, as well as learning good manners and how to hold a weapon.



PAGE

SQUIRE

At the age of 15, the page became a squire. He would clean his knight's armour and weapons, and accompany the knight to the battlefield. Squires were taught horsemanship and fighting skills.



SQUIRE

KNIGHT

At the age of about 21, a squire would be made a knight at the ceremony of dubbing. Another knight, usually the squire's master, tapped the new knight on the shoulder with the flat of a sword, and announced him as a knight.



KNIGHT

CASTLE LIVESTOCK

The castle kept a variety of animals to provide food for the community. Chickens and geese lived in the courtyard, while larger animals grazed in the fields and were brought inside the castle walls at night to keep them safe.



COTSWOLD SHEEP



CHICKENS



BAGOT GOAT

LONGHORN COW



GOOSE



BOAR

CASTLES AROUND THE WORLD

The size, shape, and location of a castle were influenced by natural features such as mountains or lakes, the climate, what building materials were available, and how permanent the castle was intended to be.



HOHENZOLLERN CASTLE, GERMANY (19TH CENTURY)



BELMONTE CASTLE, SPAIN (15TH CENTURY)



SAUMUR CASTLE, FRANCE (10TH-16TH CENTURY)



KASTELHOLM CASTLE, FINLAND (14TH CENTURY)



QATRANA CASTLE, JORDAN (16TH CENTURY)



OKAYAMA CASTLE, JAPAN (16TH CENTURY)